

Maedeh Agharazzi

m.agharazi.d@gmail.com

Education

Ph.D. of Information

Advised by Dr. Michelle Kazmer

Dissertation title: *eHealth literacy, Information Overload, and Information Avoidance in the Era of the COVID-19*

School of Information (*iSchool*), College of Communication and Information

Florida State University (FSU), Tallahassee, FL.

M.S. Sociocultural and International Development Education Studies

Department of Educational Leadership & Policy Studies, College of Education. FSU, Tallahassee, FL.

M.A. Multimedia (e-learning technologies), Multimedia University (MMU), Cyberjaya, Malaysia.

Thesis title: *Perception of Microblogging especially Twitter users in learning new English vocabularies*

B.S. Information System Engineering, MMU, Cyberjaya, Malaysia.

Thesis title: *Map the Star*

Work Experience

Adjunct professor, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, iSchool—September 2025-present

Adjunct professor, Florida State University, iSchool—December 2024-present

Collaborating Faculty, Curriculum Co-Design Research

**HEX AI Lab, University of Pittsburgh, Department of Health Information Management —
Summer 2025-present**

- Engaged in a cross-institutional research collaboration in topics related to use of AI chatbots in support of patients, AI explainability, and Federated learning method to enhance health data results and coauthoring scholarly outputs
- Co-development of courses related to topics related to AI in healthcare

Research collaborator (unofficial), University of Florida (UF), Department of Physical Medicine and Rehabilitation—Summer 2024-present

- Contributing to the development of AI-assisted technologies aimed at supporting post-stroke patients in home-based rehabilitation following hospital discharge.
- Engaged in ideation, literature review, and grant writing to support project advancement and funding acquisition.
- Collaborating within a multidisciplinary team to integrate clinical insights and user-centered design principles and instructional design concepts into the app's development.

Offered Postdoctoral Fellowship (Position Discontinued), UF, Department of Health Outcomes and Biomedical Informatics—December 2024

Dr. Jessica Ray (offering mentor)

- Selected for a postdoctoral fellowship position focused on consumer health information and use of technology in healthcare. However, the position was discontinued due to Dr. Ray's departure from UF.

Postdoctoral Associate, UF, College of Engineering—Spring 2022-Summer 2024

Dr. Kristy Boyer (Mentor)

- **Led a usability study on a smartwatch application for collaboration between runner dyads—
Under supervision of Dr. Boyer—Spring 2023-Summer 2024.**

Actively participated in meetings with developers, providing insights to enhance functionality and user experience and refining applications tailored for a variety of smartwatches.

- Ensured usability through rigorous testing of developed applications.

- As Principal Investigator (PI) for the Collaborative Running Study, managed IRB documentation, RedCap documentation and consent forms, and the recruitment process both online and in-person.
 - Preparing and conducting survey questionnaires pre and post-study in the Qualtrics in addition to the pre and post-study interviews with participants.
 - Preliminary qualitative analysis of the collected data for a prospective thematic analysis paper.
- **Led a usability study on a phone application facilitating collaboration between cyclist dyads–Under supervision of Dr. Boyer–Fall 2022–Spring 2023.**
 - Actively participated in meetings with developers, providing insights to enhance functionality and user experience.
 - Mentored two undergraduate students in application development.
 - Conducted multiple testing sessions and led the usability study to evaluate application usability.
 - Prepared Institutional Review Board (IRB) documentation, designed screening processes, and recruitment process.
 - Conducted interviews to gather participant feedback and analyzed the collected data which led to the authorship of a paper detailing study results.
- **Research assistant in Children’s heart rate study–Fall 2023**
 - Participated in data collection of a research testing a smartwatch application with children aged 9-12 to evaluate children’s heart rate comprehension and usability of the smartwatch application.
 - Assisted in data analysis and synthesized findings which led to writing a research article.

Teaching Assistant, FSU, iSchool—Summer 2021

Information Architecture (LIS5786)

- Assisted the instructor with grading and providing feedback to students' projects and homework (e.g., reviewing students' websites' information architecture) plus facilitating the online class activities.

Teaching Assistant, FSU, iSchool—Summer 2021

Design and Production of Networked Multimedia (LIS5362)

- Graded students' midterm and final exams.
- Helped students to create their website using HTML and CSS by having office hour sessions, providing feedback and grading their projects.

Teaching Assistant, FSU, iSchool—Spring 2021, Spring 2020

Digital Media (LIS5313)

- Graded students' projects and facilitated the class organization.
- Provided feedback to students on how to design, create and enhance multimedia projects, e.g., creating posters, podcasts, and short videos based on design principles.

Research Assistant (volunteer), FSU, College of Psychology—Fall 2020-Fall 2021

Under supervision of Drs. Walter Boot and Zhe He

- Was part of the Adherence Promotion with Person-centered Technology (APPT) team which is a multi-disciplinary project that received a 2.9 million grant from NIH to investigate promoting Adherence and Enhances the Early Detection and Treatment of Cognitive Decline. This project develops AI-based reminder systems to help ensure long-term engagement with home-based cognitive assessment and cognitive training protocols. As a part of this group, I analyzed qualitative data collected through surveys and focus groups. Also, I contributed to writing an article on the motivational causes of participation of older adults in research projects.

Lead Instructor, FSU, iSchool—Fall 2020

Information Ethics in 21st Century (IDS2144)

- Prepared and updated new contents based on the syllabus provided.
- Developed lesson plans, and slides for each lecture session.

- Designed different in-class activities such as case studies and homework activities in a way to trigger students' critical thinking considering the world challenges such as COVID-19 or Black Lives Matters such as discussion boards and debates.
- Assessing students' learning through different methods and assisting them improve by providing feedback on students' writing projects during the office hours.

Teaching Assistant, FSU, iSchool—Spring 2020

Digital storytelling (LIS2527)

- Graded students' projects and presentations, facilitated the class organization, and provided feedback to students on how to frame their narratives and improve their storytelling projects.

Graduate Assistant, FSU, iSchool—Fall 2019

- Preparing enrollment reports and providing recommendations to improve enrollment rates for the master of Library Science at FSU.
- Participated in data analysis for Quality Enhancement Reviews (QER) focusing on student experiences. Additionally, collaborated within FSU's iSchool to create reports, develop data visualizations, and facilitate requirements for ALA reviews conducted every seven years.
- Assisted the admission office to collect data by conducting phone surveys with alumni and current students to investigate their experience in the Master of Library Science program .

Teaching Assistant, FSU, iSchool—Spring 2019, Spring 2021

Management of Information Organizations (LIS5408)

- Graded students' projects and provided feedback to students for completing their final project on different aspects of managing the information organizations, plus facilitating in-class group work activities.

Research experience, DIS, FSU, iSchool—Spring 2019

Under supervision of Dr. Chris Hinnant

- Conducting research on theoretical concepts including trust and data-driven decision-making approaches toward using big data in medium and small-size companies.
- Acquired expertise in crafting effective survey questions and developing questionnaires in Qualtrics, and implementing strategies to enhance response rates
- Initiated the exploration of fundamental concepts in Python programming.

Research Assistant, FSU, iSchool—Fall 2018-Summer 2019

Under supervision of Dr. Yolanda Rankin

- Contributed to qualitative research analysis for an FSU-funded project investigating the underrepresentation of African-American women in the computing pipeline using N-Vivo.
- Writing a paper examining the impact of family dynamics on the engagement of African-American women in computing based on the collected interviews.
- Provided mentorship to an undergraduate student, offering guidance in basic statistical data analysis, instruction in utilizing N-Vivo software and coding within it, and training in qualitative data analysis techniques."

Teaching Assistant, FSU, iSchool—Fall 2018

Assessing Information needs (LIS5203)

- Same course but two instructors on two different platforms—online and face-to-face.
- Graded student's essays and provided feedback to students for completing their final project, helped and guided them on how to write a scholarly paper during office hours.
- Had two lecture sessions about information poverty theory in online and face-to-face classes.

Teaching Assistant, FSU, iSchool—Spring 2018

Information organization (LIS5703)

- Graded writing projects and provided feedback to students.

Teaching Assistant, FSU, iSchool—Fall 2017

Perspective in information technology (LIS4708)

- Same course, two instructors on two different platforms—online and face-to-face.
- Provided feedback to form a proper design, create, and enhance an online website featuring as an online interactive CV.
- Engaged in some part of content development and designing class activities such as role-playing on how to negotiate for salary, or teaching Agile project management by playing some games.
- Provided a lecture on transferable skills and their importance in students' career success.

Administration Assistant, FSU, iSchool—Summer 2017

- Assisted administrative tasks related to student enrollment and assisted in preparing documents for the admissions committee to facilitate decision-making regarding prospective students' admission.

Research Assistant, FSU, College of Education—Spring 2017**Under supervision of Dr. Helen Boyle**

- Participated in qualitative data analysis for the Islamic schools in Ghana project led by Dr. Boyle, involving interviews with teachers, principals, parents, and religious leaders. Initial results were presented at the American Educational Research Association (AERA) conference.

Teaching Assistant, FSU, iSchool—Spring 2017**Empowering Health Consumers in the eHealth Era (IFS 3037)**

- The primary instructor left in the middle of the semester, I was responsible for taking care of course consistency and smooth transition.
- Classroom management, grading assignments and helping students to understand the expectations for their assignments.
- Helped students with their writing assignments and taught a lecture on a scholarly paper structure and how students should use APA.

Teaching Assistant, FSU, College of Education—Fall 2016, Fall 2015**Schooling and Development in Third World Societies (EDF 2082)**

- Graded students' homework and provided feedback on their in-class activities and writing assignments.
- Assisted the instructor to develop slides, class activities, and crafting bi-weekly quizzes
- Facilitation of class discussions to encourage students' critical thinking skills by proving controversial case studies.
- Provided some multimedia contents such as speech and videos from other cultures related to education and encouraged students to watch them and understand multicultural concepts.
- Taught four sessions on a) green and sustainable education, b) emergency education, c) harmful education, and d) gender and education.

Graduate Assistant, FSU, College of Education—Spring 2016

Under supervision of Dr. Peter Easton, chief editor of CIES journal

- Bibliography and database management of the Comparative and International Education Society (CIES) journal.

Graduate Assistant, FSU, College of Education—Spring 2016

Under supervision of Dr. Boyle

- Assisted in instruction and contributed to the redesign of the course content to enhance student engagement and alignment with learning outcomes.
- Developed the syllabus and defined learning objectives in collaboration with the course instructor.
- Identified core content areas and designed in-class activities to support diverse learning needs and promote inclusive teaching practices

Instructional Designer, Cosmopoint, Malaysia —December 2010-December 2011

- Cosmopoint was a part of a Malaysian company that supported Kuala Lumpur Metropolitan University (KLUM). In that role, I was responsible for helping instructors create their courses based on the instructional design principles, designing and developing multimedia content, and I was involved with conducting workshops for instructors to teach them how to use PowerPoints effectively in their classrooms.

IT Professional Technician, Tehran, Iran—March 2007- June 2007

- I was working in the Iranian National Science Foundation (INSF) IT helpdesk. Technical troubleshooting, conducting workshops on how to use the new automation database system, and using the new system were part of my organization's responsibility.

Internship, Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia—June 2007-October 2007

- IBTech SDN BHD was a Malaysian tech company, and as an intern, I was involved with the R&D team to facilitate designing a knowledge management system and search engines.

Grant Writing Experience

Participated in grant writing—Under supervision of Drs. Boyer and Jake-Schoffman—Spring 2023-Spring 2024

Unfunded

- “Fostering Parent-Child Physical Activity through Real-Time Collaboration and a Novel Smartwatch App: A Feasibility Pilot”
R21: NIH Exploratory/Developmental Research Grant Program (Parent R21 Clinical Trial Required)
NIH Eunice Kennedy Shriver National Institute of Child Health and Human Development (NICHD)
Submitted February 2023, Amount: \$275,000
 - Participated in meetings, discussions, and brainstorming sessions with interdisciplinary team members to form the proposed project.
 - Conducted literature reviews and synthesized relevant research findings to support the rationale and theoretical framework of the grant proposal.
- “Moved2Learn: Empowering Mother-Daughter Dyads to Learn AI in Support of their Physical Activity Goals”
Advancing Informal STEM Learning (ASIL)
NSF Division of Research on Learning
Submitted January 2023, Amount: \$1,491,229
 - Participated in meetings, discussions, and brainstorming sessions with interdisciplinary team members to form the proposed project.
 - Conducted literature reviews and synthesized relevant research findings to support the rationale and theoretical framework of the grant proposal.
- “DRPD-ROSF2024: Harnessing the Power of Artificial Intelligence to Promote Physical Activity and Community Building among College Students”
UF Research Opportunity Seed Grant
University of Florida
Submitted February 2024, Amount: \$100,000
 - Participated in meetings, discussions, and brainstorming sessions with interdisciplinary team members to form the proposed project.
 - Conducted literature reviews and synthesized relevant research findings to support the rationale and theoretical framework of the grant proposal.

- “Fostering Collaborative Parent-Child Physical Activity through a Novel AI-Powered App: A Feasibility Pilot”

R21: NIH Exploratory/Developmental Research Grant Program (Parent R21 Clinical Trial Required)

NIH Eunice Kennedy Shriver National Institute of Child Health and Human Development (NICHD)

Submitted February 2024, Amount: \$275,000

- Collaborated closely with the PIs to refine project ideas, develop research aims, and articulate the significance and innovation of the proposed project.
- Contributed to the formulation of research questions and strategies for integrating AI-supported mobile app technology into the intervention design.
- Participated in meetings, discussions, and brainstorming sessions with interdisciplinary team members to form the proposed project.
- Conducted literature reviews and synthesized relevant research findings to support the rationale and theoretical framework of the grant proposal.

Awards and Fellowships

- Best paper award for Late-breaking papers at Mobile HCI23 conference, 2023.
- COGS travel grant for attending AMIA21 conference, 2021.
- School of Information’s Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award, Spring 2019.
- William A. Kerr Fellowship award, \$6,000, FSU, 2016.

Publications

Refereed Proceedings and Journal Articles

1. Rezvani, F., Bogden, E., Mathew, J., **Agharazidermani**, M., Farahani, S., Pourhasani, P., Bruno, E., Kann, M., Horne, T., Myers, N., Davis, J., Gupta, P., Plate, J., Tafti, A., Ghazaleh, H. (2026). *Trustworthy federated learning for postoperative respiratory risk prediction following total joint arthroplasty*. **Manuscript in preparation.**
2. Pourhasani, P., Farahani, S., Rezvani, F., Bogden, E., Mathew, J., Bruno, E., Kann, M., Horne, T., Myers, N., Davis, J., Gupta, P., Plate, J., Ghazaleh, H., **Agharazidermani**, M., Tafti, A. (2026).

Federated Learning for Identifying Demographic Disparities in Cancer Survivorship Across Multi-Institutional Cohorts. Manuscript in preparation.

3. Bogden, E., Rezvani, F., Bruno, E., Poorhasani P., Farahani, S., **Agharazidermani, M.**, Mathew, J., Urish, K., Plate, J., Ghazaleh, H., Tafti, A.(2026) *Explainable Federated Learning to Predict Cardiac Complications Following Total Hip and Knee Arthroplasty. AMIA*
4. Sanogo, M., Gao, F., Littlefield, N.,..., **Agharazidermani, M.**,... *et al.* KneeXNet-2.5D: a clinically-oriented and explainable deep learning framework for MRI-based knee cartilage and meniscus segmentation. *npj Health Syst.* 3, 18 (2026).
5. Sharififar, S., **Agharazidermani, M.**, Azari, H., Yuzefovich Khanna, A., Adkins, L., Babb, C., Gonzalez, N., & Rashidi, P. (in progress). *Technology-driven assessment of gait deviations in stroke rehabilitation: A systematic review of methods and outcomes.* PROSPERO systematic review registration.
6. Lu, L., Jake-Schoffman, D. E., Lavoie, H. A., **Agharazidermani, M.**, & Boyer, K. E. (2025). Preadolescent Children Using Real-Time Heart Rate During Moderate to Vigorous Physical Activity: A Feasibility Study. *JMIR Human Factors*, 12(1), e58715.
7. **Agharazidermani, M.**, Lu, L., & Boyer, K. E. (2023, September). Exploring Real-Time Collaborative Heart Rate Displays for Cycling Partners. In *Proceedings of the 25th International Conference on Mobile Human-Computer Interaction* (pp. 1-7). Athens, Greece.
8. Carr, D., Tian, S., He, Z., Chakroborty, S., Dieciuc, M., Gray, N., **Agharazidermani, M.**, Lustria, M., Dilanchian, A., Zhang, S., Charness, N., Terracciano, A., Boot, W. (2022). Motivation to Engage in Aging Research: Are There Typologies and Predictors? *The Gerontologist*.
9. Rankin, Y., **Agharazidermani, M.**, Thomas, J. (2020). *The Role of Familial Influences in African American Women's Persistence in Computing.* In *Research on Equity & Sustained Participation in Engineering, Computing, & Technology (RESPECT) Proceedings*. March 2020 Portland, OR.
10. **Agharazidermani, M.**, Song, H., & Rahimi, S. (2011). *Microblogging as an educational tool to advance learning: case studies and recent reports.* In *EDULEARN11 Proceedings* (pp. 6181-6190). IATED. July 2011, Barcelona, Spain.

11. Rahimi, S., Song H., & **Agharazidermani M.** (2011). *Perception and experiences of undergraduate students on using second life as a learning tool.* In *EDULEARN11 Proceedings* (pp. 6181-6190). IATED. July 2011, Barcelona, Spain.

Referenced Presentations at Conferences

1. Sharififar, S., **Agharazidermani, M.**, Zadov, Y., Vincent, H.K., & Rashidi, P., (2025). *Admission Self-Care and Mobility Scores Predict Length of Stay and Discharge Outcomes in Stroke Rehabilitation.* American Academy of Physical Medicine and Rehabilitation (AAPM&R). Salt Lake City, Utah.
2. **Agharazidermani, M.**, Menard, W., Lavoie, H., Lu, L., Jake-Schoffman, D. E., & Boyer, K. E. (2024). Cycling is a Collaborative Sport and Cycling HCI Needs More Collaboration Research. *CyclingHCI*. CHI 2024, Honolulu, HI, USA.
3. **Agharazidermani, M.**, (2023) *Facilitating collaborative physical activity through real-time information sharing.* Postdoctoral Seminars. Gainesville, FL.
4. Carr, D. C., He, Z., Lustria, M. L. A., Tian, S., **Agharazidermani, M.**, Boot, W. R. (2021, November 10-13). *Factors That Motivate Older Adults to Participate in Research: Typologies and Implications* [Virtual Presentation]. Gerontological Society of America, Virtual Conference. (International)
5. Muhamad, J.S., Huse, L.K., Wibowo, P., Tian, M., Gunaydin, F., Wendorf Muhamad, J., Merle, P., & **Agharazidermani, M.** (2020). *Information Sharing for Collective Action: Exploring Retweets during the COVID-19 Pandemic.* Paper submitted to the 106th National Communication Association conference. Indianapolis, IN.
6. Huse, L.K., Muhamad, J.S., Wendorf Muhamad, J., Wibowo, M., Tian, M., Merle, P. Gunaydin, F., & **Agharazidermani, M.** (2020). *Baby Yoda Recommends Washing Hands": A Content Analysis of Memes on COVID-19.* Paper submitted to the 106th National Communication Association conference. Indianapolis, IN.
7. Merle, P., Wendorf Muhamad, J., Huse, L.K., Wibowo, P., Gunaydin, F., Muhamad, J.S., & **Agharazidermani, M.** (2020). *Who framed COVID-19 and how: Examining the local and national*

communication patterns on the pandemic. Paper submitted to the 103rd Annual Association for Education in Journalism and Mass Communication conference. San Francisco, California.

8. Muhamad, J.S., Wendorf Muhamad, J., Tian, M., Gunaydin, F., Merle, P., Huse, L.K., Wibowo, P., & **Agharazidermani**, M. (2020). *“Chinese Virus” as Anchor for Engaging with COVID-19 Information: Anchor Bias leading to Racism and Xenophobia*. Paper submitted to ALISE 2020 annual conference. Pittsburg, PA.
9. Wibowo, P., Wendorf Muhamad, J., Muhamad, J.S., & **Agharazidermani**, M. Gunaydin, F., Merle, P., Huse, L.K., Tian, M. (2020). *Analysis of Public Perceptions of Multiple Community Issues through Social Media Mining during a Pandemic*. Paper submitted to ALISE 2020 Annual conference. Pittsburgh, PA.
10. Boyle, H. N., & **Agharazidermani**, M. (2017). *Blending Islamic and Western Traditions of Education: Integrated Islamic Schools in Ghana*. Paper Presented at American Educational Research Association, San Antonio, TX.

Teaching Experience: Courses Taught and Assigned

- Race Gender and Information Technology (IS 308), Fall2026, UIUC
- Health Information Systems and Management (LIS 5788), Spring 2025, 2026, FSU
- Information Ethics in 21st Century (LIS 2144), Fall 2020, FSU

Guest Lectures

- Information Behavior—graduate course FSU iSchool (LIS 5203)—Information Consumption, Information Overload, and Information Avoidance in the Era of the COVID-19

Courses Teaching Assistant

- Information Architecture (LIS5786)
- Design and Production of Networked Multimedia (LIS5362)
- Digital Media (LIS 5313)
- Digital Storytelling (LIS 2527)
- Management of Information Organizations (LIS 5408)
- Assessing Information (LIS 5203)

- Information Organization (LIS 5703)
- Perspective in Information Technology (LIS 4708)
- Empowering Health Consumers in the eHealth Era (IFS 3037)
- Schooling and Development in Third World Societies course (EDF 2082)

Audio/Visual Projects

- **Producer and Co-Creator, *T-Pod*** — A podcast dedicated to exploring questions about learning and education. In each episode, two hosts respond to audience questions through evidence-based discussions on topics related to learning sciences and cognitive processes, aiming to make academic insights accessible to a broader audience.
- Rahimi, S., **Agharazidermani, M.** (2017, July). Interview with John Keller - The beautiful mind behind the ARCS model of motivation [original video]. Tallahassee, FL. See the interview here: <https://youtu.be/VSEAOtX8e04>

Service

- AMIA 2021 Annual Symposium Student Volunteer Program
- Mentoring and teaching an undergraduate student to work in Detour lab on data analysis on the project of underrepresentation of African American women in computing.
- Doctoral Students' representative in the Student Experience Committee at school of information (2019-2020)

Membership in Professional Organizations

- Association of Computing Machinery (ACM)
- Association for Library and Information Science Education (ALISE)
- American Medical Informatics Association (AMIA)

Certificates

- AI Fundamentals—Certificate of completion by Data Camp—2021
- Social network analysis using R—certificate of completion by Lynda.com—June 2020
- Learning Python—certificate of completion by Lynda.com —March 2019
- Program Evaluation certificate by College of Education in Florida State University— 2017
- A two-day workshop including contents like Needs Assessment, design a learning system, implement a system, and evaluate its outcomes—July 2016
- Developing ASP.NET Web Applications and XML Web Services with Microsoft Visual C#.NET and Microsoft Visual Studio.NET certificate given by Microsoft—2006

- Installing, Configuring, and Administering Microsoft SQL Server 2000 Enterprise Edition certificate issued by Microsoft—2006

Software/Applications

N-Vivo, R, Mplus, Weka, SPSS, HTML, Python, Microsoft Office, Adobe Photoshop, Premier, Dreamweaver, Articulate Storyline.